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MySQL Views

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MySQL CREATE VIEW Statement

An SQL view is a virtual table based on the result-set of an SQL statement. An SQL view contains rows and columns, just like a real table. The fields in the view are fields from one or more real tables in the database.

You can add SQL statements and functions to a view and present the data as if it were coming from one single table.

A view is created with the `CREATE VIEW` statement.

CREATE VIEW Syntax

```
CREATE VIEW view_name AS
SELECT column1, column2, ...
```

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Note: A view always shows real-time data! The database engine only stores the view's definition (the SELECT statement), not a copy of the data.

CREATE VIEW Examples

The following SQL creates a view named "brazil_customers_view", that shows all customers from Brazil:

Example

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```
CREATE VIEW brazil_customers_view AS
SELECT CustomerName, ContactName
FROM Customers
WHERE Country = 'Brazil';
```

To query the view above, use the following SQL syntax:

Example

```
SELECT * FROM brazil_customers_view;
```

The following SQL creates a view named "products_above_average_price", that selects all products in the "Products" table with a Price higher than the average price:

Example

```
CREATE VIEW products_above_average_price AS
SELECT ProductName, Price
```

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To query the view above, use the following SQL syntax:

Example

```
SELECT * FROM products_above_average_price;
```

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CREATE OR REPLACE VIEW Statement

In MySQL, a view can be updated with the `CREATE OR REPLACE VIEW` statement.

CREATE OR REPLACE VIEW Syntax

```
CREATE OR REPLACE VIEW view_name AS
SELECT column1, column2, ...
FROM table_name
WHERE condition;
```

The following SQL adds the "City" column to the "brazil_customers_view" view:

Example

```
CREATE OR REPLACE VIEW brazil_customers_view AS
SELECT CustomerName, ContactName, City
```

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DROP VIEW Statement

A view is deleted with the `DROP VIEW` statement.

DROP VIEW Syntax

```
DROP VIEW view_name;
```

The following SQL drops the "brazil_customers_view" view:

Example

```
DROP VIEW brazil_customers_view;
```

Exercise

Drag and drop the correct keywords to make sense of the following syntax code:

```
          Norwegians AS
          Firstname, Lastname
          Persons
          Country = 'Norway';
```

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